

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/14: The therapeutic architecture and the answer-worthiness map

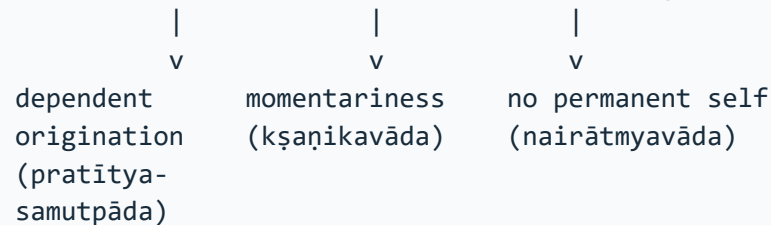
PRINTED SYLLABUS, ITEM 14 (verbatim)

"Schools of Buddhism : Prat Ityasamutpada; Ksanikavada, Nairatmyavada."

normalised -> pratītyasamutpāda | kṣaṇikavāda | nairātmyavāda

FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS (catvāri āryasatyāni) = the frame that generates everything

- 1 suffering (duḥkha) IS -> the diagnosis
- 2 suffering HAS AN ORIGIN -> needs a causal theory
- 3 the origin CAN BE REMOVED -> needs impermanence
- 4 a PATH exists -> needs a changeable person



=> THE THREE PRINTED TERMS ARE THE THREE COMMITMENTS THE THERAPY REQUIRES.

THREE DISTINCT DENIALS – never merge them

- unorthodox (nāstika) -> rejects VEDIC AUTHORITY (not "atheist")
- non-theistic -> rejects a NECESSARY CREATOR (not materialist)
- anti-substantialist -> rejects a PERMANENT SELF (not the person)

ANSWER-WORTHINESS

- CORE
pratītyasamutpāda · kṣaṇikavāda · nairātmyavāda · both Middle Paths · Noble Eightfold Path · three marks · twelve links · five aggregates · nirvāṇa · Triratna · four schools · 13 PYQs
- CORE SUPPORT
pramāṇa theory · apoha · avyākṛta silence · creator-God critique
- OPTIONAL ONLY
Madhyamaka interpretation dispute · Yogācāra idealism debate · Puḍgalavāda · two truths and ethics · Western comparisons

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/14: The double Middle Path

MIDDLE PATH (madhyamā pratipad; Pali: majjhimā paṭipadā) – TWO SENSES, ONE LOGIC

PRACTICAL	sensual indulgence X----- MIDDLE -----X self-mortification
	(kāma-sukhallikānuyoga) (attakilamathānuyoga)
	POSITIVE CONTENT: NOBLE EIGHTFOLD PATH (āryāṣṭāṅgamārga)
wisdom (prajñā)	1 right view (samyag-dṛṣṭi)
	2 right intention (samyak-saṃkalpa)
ethical discipline (śīla)	3 right speech (samyag-vāc)
	4 right action (samyak-karmānta)
	5 right livelihood (samyag-ājīva)
meditative discipline	6 right effort (samyag-vyāyāma)
(samādhi)	7 right mindfulness (samyak-smṛti)
	8 right concentration (samyak-samādhi)

WHY REJECTED: indulgence FEEDS craving; mortification EXHAUSTS without touching it.

TEST APPLIED: causal efficacy against craving – NOT balance, NOT moderation.

DOCTRINAL eternalism X----- MIDDLE -----X annihilationism
 (śāśvatavāda) (ucchedavāda)

POSITIVE CONTENT: CONDITIONED CONTINUITY
change without a permanent bearer;
continuity without an identical persisting thing

STRUCTURAL TEST eternalism would defeat TRUTH 3 (a permanent cause cannot be removed)
annihilationism would defeat TRUTH 4 (no continuity for discipline)

SHARED HIDDEN ASSUMPTION DENIED: "continuity requires an identical persisting thing"

OPERATIVE TARGET the path attacks IGNORANCE (by insight) and the FEELING -> CRAVING junction (by mindfulness): feeling is unavoidable, craving is not.

TRAP X defining the Middle Path as moderation or an Aristotelian mean.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/14: Who is speaking – traditions, labels, canons, ideals

EARLY BUDDHISM

(earliest recoverable discourse + discipline traditions;
common core: four truths, middle path, conditionality, three marks)

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+-----+-----+

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NON-MAHĀYĀNA WORLD

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MAHĀYĀNA WORLD

THERAVĀDA one surviving school

canon: Pali Tipiṭaka

Vinaya | Sutta | Abhidhamma

ideal: liberated saint (arhat;

Pali: arahant)

YOGĀCĀRA consciousness-only

MĀDHYAMIKA emptiness

ideal: awakening being

(bodhisattva) -> complete

Buddhahood for all beings

SARVĀSTIVĀDA ORBIT

VAIBHĀṢIKA from the Kashmir *Mahāvibhāṣā*

SAUTRĀNTIKA privileges sūtra over Abhidharma

transmission: Sanskrit / Chinese / Tibetan transmission: Sanskrit + Buddhist

Hybrid Sanskrit, Chinese, Tibetan

"HĪNAYĀNA" = a MAHĀYĀNA-APPLIED, historically loaded label for disciple-vehicle
traditions. NOT a self-designation. NOT a synonym for Theravāda.

CAUTIONS THAT CARRY MARKS

X "all early Buddhism survives only in Pali" -> Chinese Āgamas + Sanskrit witnesses

X "Mahāyāna = Sanskrit" -> broad orientation only

X "selfish arhat vs altruistic bodhisattva" -> Theravāda knows the bodhisatta
career; Mahāyāna knows the arhat

X "the four schools are the history of Buddhism" -> it is a PHILOSOPHICAL DOXOGRAPHY

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/14: Dependent origination – formula, argument, three marks

FORMULA (in substance, four clauses – quote ALL FOUR)

imasmim sati idam hoti	this being, that becomes
imass' uppada idam uppajjati	from the arising of this, that arises
imasmim asati idam na hoti	this not being, that is not
imassa nirodha idam nirujjhati	from the cessation of this, that ceases

PAIR 1 = positive conditionality PAIR 2 = negative conditionality
=> CESSATION IS BUILT INTO THE PRINCIPLE; truth 3 is an ENTAILMENT.

ARGUMENT (write in this order)

- 1 what is experienced is not self-grounding; it occurs only in dependence
- 2 a self-existent thing would not depend on conditions
- 3 all conditioned phenomena arise and cease in dependence
- 4 therefore they are neither eternal substances nor sheer nothingness
- 5 therefore suffering too is a process, not a fate -> it is REMOVABLE

THREE MARKS (trilakṣaṇa; Pali: tilakkhaṇa)

SCOPE – examinable

impermanence (anitya; Pali: anicca)	-> of conditioned formations
unsatisfactoriness (duḥkha; Pali: dukkha)	-> of conditioned formations
no-self (anātman; Pali: anattā)	-> applied MORE WIDELY

CAUTION: early impermanence is NOT verbally identical with later momentariness.

CAUTION: nirvāṇa is classified UNCONDITIONED (asaṃskṛta) in important traditions.

PRESUPPOSITION explain through CONDITIONS, not through a static substratum

(ātman / Brahman) and not through a creator outside the chain

OBJECTION infinite regress of conditions -> nothing is ultimately explained

REPLY no unconditioned substance is needed to make conditioning

intelligible; the aim is soteriological, not genetic

2023 HINGE ignorance is CAUSALLY PRODUCTIVE: misreading process as possession

generates craving; knowledge cures because the framing did work

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/14: The twelve links and where the chain is cut

1 ignorance (avidyā) -> 2 formations (saṃskāra)
3 consciousness (vijñāna) -> 4 name-and-form (nāma-rūpa)
5 six sense-bases (ṣaḍāyatana) -> 6 contact (sparśa)
7 feeling (vedanā) ===== THE CUT GOES HERE =====> 8 craving (trṣṇā)
9 clinging (upādāna) -> 10 becoming (bhava)
11 birth (jāti) -> 12 ageing-and-death (jarā-maraṇa)
FRAGILE PAIRS: formations BEFORE consciousness; craving BEFORE clinging BEFORE becoming. Reversing either is an immediately visible factual error.

THREE-LIFE ARRANGEMENT (pedagogic, not exclusive)

PAST CAUSES	1-2	already produced
PRESENT RESULTS	3-7	already produced
PRESENT CAUSES	8-10	OPEN -> this is why the chain is NOT fatalism
FUTURE RESULTS	11-12	conditional on the open box

THREE LEGITIMATE READINGS

three-life pedagogic explains rebirth and karmic continuity
present-process psychological explains contact->feeling->craving HERE AND NOW
structural-soteriological diagnoses a self-sustaining pattern, not a first cause

REVERSE ORDER (pratiloma) ignorance ceases -> formations cease -> ... ->
ageing-and-death ceases

=> the third Noble Truth becomes a LOGICAL CONSEQUENCE, not a hope.

TWO CUT-POINTS ignorance -> removed by INSIGHT (wisdom training)
craving -> removed by DISCIPLINE + MINDFULNESS

VISUAL PEDAGOGY wheel of becoming (bhava-cakra) – a WHEEL because avidyā is
itself conditioned, so no absolutely first cause is claimed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/14: Momentariness – the elimination argument

THESIS yat sat tat kṣaṇikam – whatever is real is momentary
(scholastic, in substance: sattve satyeva kṣaṇikatvam)

CRITERION sat = arthakriyā-samartha – the real is what CAN PRODUCE AN EFFECT
(causal efficacy, arthakriyākāritva)

SUPPOSE A PERMANENT ENTITY IS CAUSALLY EFFICIENT.

HORN 1 – SIMULTANEITY (yugapadya) produces the whole effect at once -> NOTHING LEFT for later production	HORN 2 – SUCCESSION (krama) produces effects at different times -> FUNCTIONS DIFFERENTLY -> HAS CHANGED
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NYĀYA ESCAPE: "it acts only when auxiliaries (sahakārin) are present"

CLOSED BY sahakāri-anapekṣā: either the power was ALREADY there
(auxiliaries idle)
or the auxiliaries SUPPLY it
(permanent thing redundant)

PERMANENT + EFFICIENT = INCOHERENT -> yat sat tat kṣaṇikam

SECOND ARGUMENT – DESTRUCTION (vināśītvānumāna / kṣaṇabhaṅga)

perishing needs NO external destroyer; arising already contains ceasing

=> closes the realist exit of treating destruction as an extra caused event

CONTINUITY PRESERVED causal series (santāna / santati) + similarity (sādṛśya)
illustrations: FLAME and STREAM

METHOD NOTE momentariness is established NEGATIVELY, by eliminating the permanent cause – never by perceiving moments

NYĀYA RESIDUAL	recognition (pratyabhijñā): a JUDGEMENT of sameness seems to need a subject holding both terms together
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TRAP X "momentary" means "non-existent" -> reality is EVENTAL, not substantial

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/14: No permanent self – the exhaustive analysis

THE PERSON, ANALYSED WITHOUT REMAINDER – five aggregates (pañca-skandha)

- 1 form / material body (rūpa)
- 2 feeling (vedanā) -> pleasant | unpleasant | neutral tone
- 3 perception / recognition (saṃjñā)
- 4 dispositions / formations (saṃskāra) <- INTENTION (cetanā) LIVES HERE
- 5 consciousness (vijñāna)

THE TEST APPLIED TO EACH		THE CONCLUSION
is it permanent?	NO	no sixth item is found
is it independent?	NO	-> "self" is a DESIGNATION (prajñapti)
is it fit to be "mine, I, my self"?	NO	-> conventionally valid, not ultimately self-subsistent
** THE ARGUMENT IS THE EXHAUSTIVENESS OF THE LIST **		

CHARIOT ANALOGY (Milinda-paṇḥa)

not the axle | not the wheels | not the heap | not something extra above them
=> a TERM CAN BE TRUE WITHOUT NAMING A FURTHER ENTITY
=> the chariot still carries you; the person still practises

TWO NO-SELVES – the 2021 distinction

PERSONAL (pudgala-nairātmya)	denies the enduring PERSON shared minimum across Buddhist traditions
PHENOMENON (dharma-nairātmya)	denies INTRINSIC NATURE in the factors pressed hardest by Mahāyāna / Mādhyamika

ONE-LINE CONTRAST: the first dissolves the OWNER; the second dissolves the INVENTORY on which the owner was denied.

=> Vaibhāṣika + Sautrāntika accept the first and keep a REAL inventory.

INTERNAL FOIL – Puggalavāda (Vātsīputriya)
 a person "neither identical with nor different from" the aggregates
 REJECTED by mainstream Buddhism as a relapse toward self-theory
 USE: proves the ownership pressure was felt INSIDE Buddhism and refused on principle

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/14: Continuity – karma, memory, identity, rebirth

MIDDLE FORMULA: na sa eva na cānyaḥ – NEITHER THE SAME NOR ANOTHER

strict identity -> eternalism returns

strict difference-> the fruit falls on a stranger

=> DENY THE DISJUNCTION, do not choose a branch

OBJECTION	DEVICE	HOW IT WORKS
"Who remembers?"	-> santāna	earlier experience conditions later cognition
"Who recognises?"	-> sādṛśya	similar later phase taken as numerically the same
"Who deserves?"	-> na sa eva na cānyaḥ	fruit falls on the continuous series
"What is reborn?"	-> pratisandhāna	one series RELINKS to another; nothing travels
"What stores it?"	-> ālaya-vijñāna + bīja (Yogācāra)	conditioned transforming stream, NOT an ātman

WHERE MORAL QUALITY LIVES: INTENTION (cetanā) – a formation among the aggregates

=> no bearer beyond the aggregates is needed to make an act good or bad

ILLUSTRATION: one lamp lights another – not the same flame, not an unrelated one

REBIRTH IS NOT TRANSMIGRATION

Jainism / Nyāya / Vedānta give rebirth a SUBJECT that travels

Buddhism gives rebirth a RELATION: one series conditions another

RESIDUAL FORCE (state it – "critically discuss" demands it)

a series explains SUCCESSION better than it explains OWNERSHIP

Buddhist rejoinder: desert, like ownership, is a CONVENTIONAL notion tracking

causal continuity; the demand for ULTIMATE desert presupposes an ultimate subject

TRAP X answering the karma objection by smuggling in a subtle self

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/14: Cessation, the Three Jewels and the consistency proof

NIRVĀṆA (Pali: nibbāna) = EXTINCTION OF THE THREE FIRES

attachment (rāga) | aversion (dveṣa) | delusion (moha)

=> cessation of the PROCESS that produces suffering

CLASSIFICATION: unconditioned (asaṃskṛta) in important traditions

= OUTSIDE the dependent series, NOT a substance with properties

X not another momentary event X not an eternal self attained

THE CONSISTENCY PROOF (2018 Q6b · 2025 Q8c) – four moves

1 "who attains?" ASSUMES the very self Buddhism denies

2 nirvāṇa is NOT an entity possessed by a soul

3 it IS the cessation of craving, ignorance and the suffering-series

4 => CONSONANCE: no-self removes the false claimant;

momentariness explains why the chain CAN cease

MUTUAL SUPPORT: permanent self -> liberation impossible

non-momentary events -> chain uninteruptible

unconditioned process -> cessation would not follow

THREE JEWELS (Triratna) – 2022 Q7b asks for the INTERNAL RELATION

BUDDHA discovered and demonstrated the path

DHARMA the teaching and the truth it states – THIS IS WHAT LIBERATES

SAṄGHA preserves, transmits and exemplifies it

ORIGIN ORDER : Buddha -> Dharma -> Saṅgha

ACCESS ORDER : Saṅgha -> Dharma -> Buddha

CONSISTENCY : the refuge-taker is the CONVENTIONAL PERSON (prajñapti-puruṣa);

a series capable of being conditioned by instruction is all that

refuge requires – no-self PURIFIES refuge of ego-metaphysics

TRADITION NUANCE Theravāda foregrounds the liberated saint (arhat; Pali: arahant)

Mahāyāna foregrounds the awakening being (bodhisattva)

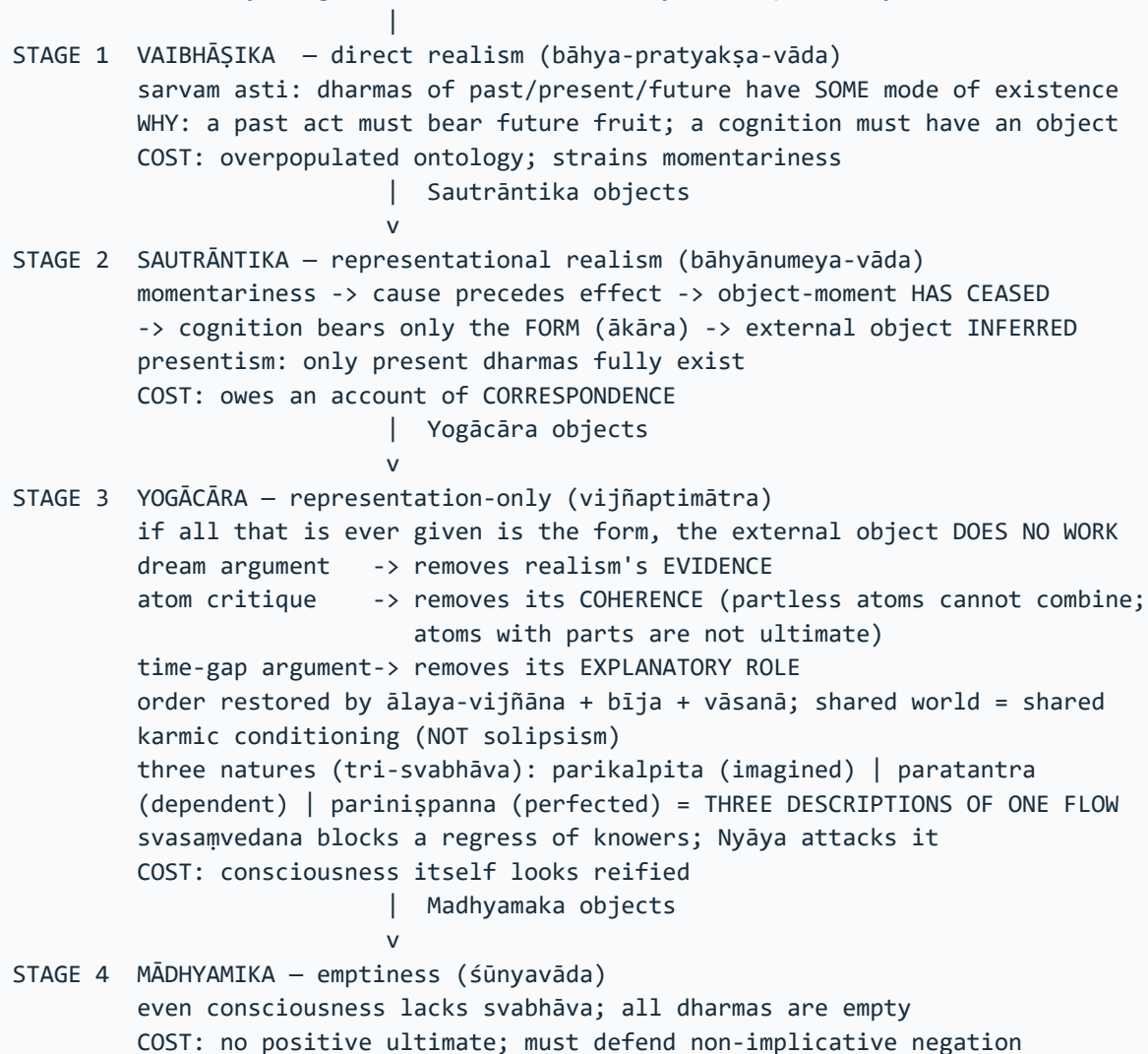
X never the "selfish vs altruistic" caricature

NĀGĀRJUNA saṃsāra and nirvāṇa are NOT two independent realms

RESIDUAL "I am liberated" is a conventional index; the Advaitic unity-of-experience objection is answered by REFUSAL, not by explanation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/14: The four schools as one escalation

SHARED PREMISE: everything conditioned is momentary and dependently arisen



2024 HINGE – "everything is real" AND "everything is void" from ONE premise
realists: dependence proves ABSENCE OF PERMANENCE -> real = CAUSALLY EFFICACIOUS
Mādhyamika: dependence proves ABSENCE OF INTRINSIC NATURE -> empty
=> not a contradiction; a DIFFERENT CRITERION OF THE ULTIMATELY REAL
(causal efficacy vs independence)

PLACEMENT X Vaibhāṣika / Sautrāntika are NOT Theravāda branches – Sarvāstivāda orbit

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/14: Emptiness – derivation, four corners, two truths

SIX-STEP DERIVATION TO EMPTINESS (2018 Q5b)

- 1 svabhāva = existing through oneself, independently
- 2 the self-existent does not await conditions
- 3 everything conditioned awaits conditions
- 4 therefore nothing conditioned has svabhāva
- 5 to lack svabhāva is to be EMPTY (śūnya)
- 6 therefore the DEPENDENTLY ARISEN IS THE EMPTY (Nāgārjuna's identification)

FOUR CORNERS (catuṣkoṭi) asti | nāsti | asti ca nāsti ca | naivāsti naiva nāsti

ALL FOUR DENIED – but SCOPED: "of x taken as having svabhāva"

NEGATION TYPE: prasajya-pratiṣedha (non-implicative) NOT paryudāsa (implicative)

=> no fifth thesis is installed; the QUESTION is withdrawn

IF the negation were IMPLICATIVE, denying all four WOULD be contradiction –

the SCOPE plus the NEGATION TYPE is the whole reply to the irrationalism charge

DEFENCES: "no thesis (pratijñā) of my own" (Vigrahavyāvartanī) | "my words are empty too" | one magically created figure (nirmitaka) counteracts another

TWO TRUTHS saṃvṛti-satya persons, causation, karma, compassion, practice FUNCTION

paramārtha-satya no dharma has own-being

conventional truth is NOT falsehood; it is where the path operates

WARNING: emptiness wrongly grasped destroys, like a SNAKE WRONGLY SEIZED

SAFEGUARD: EMPTINESS OF EMPTINESS – emptiness is itself dependent designation

POSITIVE FORM: emptiness is the CONDITION OF POSSIBILITY of change and liberation

-- if things had fixed natures, nothing could arise, alter or be freed

TRAP X emptiness = non-existence X emptiness = Advaita Brahman

 X "Nāgārjuna rejects logic" X omitting the two truths from the answer

[CONTESTED] whether non-implicative negation can be sustained without covertly

 functioning as a thesis – the Prāsaṅgika/Svātantrika division marks it

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/14: Knowing, meaning and the silence

BUDDHIST MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (Dignāga · Dharmakīrti)

TWO OBJECTS -> TWO PRAMĀṆAS

svalakṣaṇa (unique particular) momentary | causally efficient | ineffable |
ultimately real -> PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa)
sāmānyalakṣaṇa (general character) constructed | expressible | causally inert |
conventionally real -> INFERENCE (anumāna)

upamāna, arthāpatti, anupalabdhi, śabda are REDUCED, not omitted

PERCEPTION = kalpanāpoḍha (non-conceptual, Dignāga) + abhīranta (non-erroneous,
Dharmakīrti – excludes the double moon and the whirling-firebrand circle)

FOUR TYPES: indriya | mānasa | svasaṃvedana | yogi-pratyakṣa

APOHA: "cow" = "not-non-cow" via anya-apoha; grounded in SHARED CAUSAL CAPACITY

OBJECTION (Kumārila Bhaṭṭa, Uddyotakara): circular + no positive determination
pramāṇa = pramāṇaphala : instrument NOT ultimately different from result,
because there is NO ENDURING KNOWER to hold the triad apart
(Nyāya keeps pramātṛ | pramāṇa | prameya | pramiti distinct)

WHY IT IS NOT "NYĀYA WITH FEWER PRAMĀṆAS": the count is fixed by the OBJECT-SIDE,
universals are denied, and the knower is dissolved (2025 Q5b routed contrast)

UNDECLARED QUESTIONS (avyākata / avyākṛta)

world eternal? not eternal? finite? infinite?

jīva same as the body? different from it?

Tathāgata after death: exists? does not? both? neither?

TWO REASONS na arthasaṃhita (not conducive) – ARROW PARABLE, Cūḷamālukya
PRESUPPOSITIONAL DEFECT – all four options assume a substantial subject

FIRE SIMILE a fire gone out has not gone east/west/north/south

THREE READINGS agnostic (weakest) | pragmatic-therapeutic | logical-semantic

EXAM USE: COMBINE THE LAST TWO

BRIDGE the four options ARE the four corners; the early tradition sets them
aside therapeutically, Nāgārjuna shows LOGICALLY why they must be

CREATOR-GOD CRITIQUE = REFUSAL OF EXPLANATORY SURPLUS (one or two lines only;
owned by Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and Paper II)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/14: Named objections, replies, residues and comparisons

FIVE OBJECTIONS, ONE COMPLAINT: BUDDHISM REMOVED THE OWNER AND KEPT THE PROPERTY

NYĀYA (Vātsyāyana/Uddyotakara/Udayana) memory, recognition, desert need a self

REPLY santāna + sādṛśya + flame/river (+ ālaya-vijñāna, bīja)

RESIDUAL a series may not OWN memories unless something owns the series

NYĀYA REALIST (2) a permanent substance acts when auxiliaries are present

REPLY sahakāri-anapekṣā / krama-yaugapadya dilemma

RESIDUAL the substance-quality model remains intuitively powerful

KUMĀRILA BHAṬṬA self for duty and memory; real universals for word-meaning

REPLY momentary cognitions + apoha explain both conventionally

RESIDUAL positive determination unexplained

ŚAMKARA-TYPE ADVAITA liberation and unity of knower unintelligible without a witness

REPLY two truths + self-revealing cognition without a self

RESIDUAL unity of experience is the strongest surviving pressure

NYĀYA / REALIST emptiness collapses into nihilism; "no thesis" is self-refuting

REPLY scoped non-implicative negation + two truths + empty words as medicine

RESIDUAL Prāsaṅgika-Svātantrika split shows internal unease

ALL THREE karma without a self is unjust

REPLY neither identity nor utter difference; conventional desert

RESIDUAL is causal continuity ENOUGH for desert, or only for explanation?

COMPARISONS – one line each, and never reversed

vs JAINISM both non-Vedic, both non-creationist; JAINISM AFFIRMS a real conscious soul (jīva), permanence-in-substance + change-in-mode.

X NEVER "both deny the soul"

vs ADVAITA both deny naive realism; Advaita's ultimate is POSITIVE self-luminous Brahman, Madhyamaka's is the ABSENCE of own-being.

X NEVER "emptiness = Brahman"

vs CĀRVĀKA both reject an eternal self; Cārvāka reduces to BODY and abolishes rebirth/karma/liberation; Buddhism analyses into AGGREGATES and keeps them without a bearer (2024 Q6a routed contrast)

vs NYĀYA enduring self + real universals + four pramāṇas + instrument distinct from result VERSUS momentary particulars + apoha + two pramāṇas + pramāṇa = pramāṇaphala (2025 Q5b routed contrast)

INTERNAL Vaibhāṣika direct vs Sautrāntika inferred; Yogācāra consciousness-only vs Mādhyamika emptiness of consciousness too

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/14: Verdict grid, answer rail and the closing line

GRADED VERDICT GRID (use one cell per column for a balanced conclusion)

STRONG process account of suffering/causation/liberation | the double middle |
 causal-efficacy argument | two truths without abolishing practice

WEAK ownership of memory and desert | positive determination under apoha |
 stability of "no thesis" without the negation nuance

CONTESTED does svasaṃvedana prove or reify? | do empty statements self-refute? |
 is a causal series sufficient for MORAL responsibility?

USE 10 marks = one cell | 15 marks = one from STRONG + one from WEAK
 20 marks = one from EACH column

ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS define in one line -> 3-4 crisp argument steps -> ONE distinction
 -> one line of significance

15 MARKS locate in soteriology -> doctrine stated precisely -> argument with one
 example -> NAMED objection and reply -> why it matters for cessation

20 MARKS frame through the Four Noble Truths -> full doctrine with technical
 vocabulary -> DERIVE the linked claim -> contrast two schools or answer a
 major objection -> graded verdict from the grid

ANSWER RAIL – follow it and the script writes itself

four truths frame -> dependent origination formula (all four clauses)
-> twelve links + the cut at feeling->craving
-> momentariness via causal efficacy + the two horns + sahakāri-anapekṣā
-> five aggregates -> no-self -> two no-selves
-> continuity: na sa eva na cānyaḥ, santāna, cetanā, relinking
-> nirvāṇa: extinction of three fires + unconditioned + four consistency moves
-> four-school escalation -> exact contrast demanded by the question
-> named objection + reply + RESIDUAL FORCE
-> QUALIFIED VERDICT from the grid

PYQ ANCHORS 2018 Q5b/Q6b · 2019 Q5b/Q7c · 2020 Q6a/Q7b · 2021 Q5d/Q7b ·

 2022 Q6a/Q7b · 2023 Q8a · 2024 Q6b · 2025 Q8c [13 primary-owned]

ROUTED 2018 Q5d and 2025 Q5b (Nyāya-owned) · 2024 Q6a (Cārvāka-owned)

CLOSE Buddhism replaces substance with conditioned process: this makes suffering
 removable, and leaves OWNERSHIP as its one genuinely unfinished problem.